

Pick and choose your programme!

But how does one choose an appropriate programme. The key lies in choosing the right institute and course. Some of the options available are:

Enterux Solutions

Enterux Solutions offers courses on Asterisk. The advanced five-day course for the more experienced Asterisk user will help the candidate learn to create advanced dial plans and create innovative telephony solutions by using the features of Asterisk. It is a combination of both lectures and lab work, designed to give students both the theory behind the concepts, and the hands-on experience to effectively deploy Asterisk-based solutions. Further details at: www.enterux.com

Institute of Open Source

The mission of the Institute of Open Source is to make rare open source technologies reach all those who have an interest in software development. The institute offers courses in the PHP core, advanced JAVA and Perl, a basic and advanced course in Linux, different server configuration courses, a certificate course in Web administration and a certificate course in being a Web master. Further details at: www.ios.net.in

Integer Education

This is a global training services company, offering courses in Linux and PHP. There are two variants – basic training for freshers and advanced training for practising professionals. Further details at: www.integreducation.com

Lynux Academy

This institute offers courses in systems administration, tech support and DBA support. It provides training on RHCE, LPI (an international vendor-neutral Linux certificate), virtualisation, high availability clusters, troubleshooting, building secure Web applications, MySQL/PostgreSQL administration, etc. Further details at: www.lynusacademy.com

NACE Solutions

NACE Solutions provides open source consultation on migration and cost saving solutions, open source Web development and software training on Linux, Apache, MySQL, PHP, CSS, JavaScript, AJAX and Flex. The firm also provides training on Hibernate, Struts, Spring, and OpenOffice.org. It is the 'gold training' and solution provider partner for Novell. Further details at: <http://naceedu.com>

Network NUTS

Established in 2003, Network NUTS is a Delhi-based IT training company that focuses solely on systems administrators and the security track of programs. Common available courses are RHCE, RHCS, RHCA and virtualisation. The courses are available on a full-time and part-time basis and the duration varies from 32 to 100 hours. Further details at: www.networknuts.net

OSSCube

India's only Zend-authorized training partner and authorised MySQL education centre, OSSCube provides hands-on training on a number of open source software and technologies. It offers courses in MySQL, Zend, Sugar CRM, Symphony 1.2 and Doctrine, Ruby on Rails, and Python. Further details at: <http://osscube.com>

Red Hat

Rated as the No 1 vendor in IT training by IDC, Red Hat offers performance-based training with hands-on, real world skills that IT professionals need to design, execute, and maintain successful open source infrastructures. It offers courses in systems administration, JBoss, and development. Further details at: www.redhat.com/training

are the kind of FOSS professionals in demand," says Minocha. Thus, LAMP (Linux, Apache, MySQL and PHP), LARM (Linux, Apache, Ruby on Rails and MySQL), JAVA, systems administrator courses like RHCE, SUSE, Asterisk for VOIP services, and JBOSS for application server are the beneficial skillsets to acquire.

...for Web development

A reputed freelancing site, Elance.com, claimed that PHP developers are the most in demand with approximately 600 projects on the site while Odesk, another freelancing site, put the number of active PHP projects at 1,487. PHP skillsets are red hot in the field of Web development. "Apart from PHP, a professional should have knowledge of CSS 2.0, JavaScript and HTML, and Linux in the area of Web development," says Chikkara.

Gopal S, CEO, Nace Solutions, adds: "LAMP plays a major role in almost all Web development companies. There is an acute shortage of LAMP professionals across the globe, especially in India. LAMP has become more popular because of its scalable, low cost, more secure and great performance." The LAMP stack has moved beyond its position as a Web developer's creative toolkit and become a major development platform for the enterprise. Long a cornerstone of the Web's highest volume sites, including the likes of Amazon, Friendster and Google, LAMP has more recently been used to create major online transactional systems for Boeing, Disney, Lufthansa and Sabre.

...for systems administrators

The demand for FOSS systems administrators has also multiplied with the growth in the number of installations or applications on FOSS/Linux. The